



The Opinion Line

A statement goes on the board and everyone stands somewhere on a line between agree and disagree, then two or three of them say why they stood where they did. It gets a form used to disagreeing with each other out loud, and to moving when somebody makes a better point. This is Volume One.

Before you start. The statements are about opinions rather than anything personal, and nobody has to explain where they are standing. If a statement lands near something that is already going on in your form, skip it and use the next one.

Print these

Page	What it is
Page 2	The agree sign, for one wall
Page 3	The disagree sign, for the wall opposite

How it works

Step	What happens	Slides
1	Put the two signs up at opposite ends of the room before the first morning. They can stay up all year.	1
2	Put the morning's statement on the board and read it out once, without saying what you think.	2 to 6
3	Everyone stands somewhere between the two signs. The middle is a real answer, and so is moving while they are still deciding.	
4	Ask two or three of them why they stood where they did, then ask whether anybody wants to move.	
5	When the five in the slides and the five below are used up, the last slide asks students to bring you a statement of their own.	7

Worth knowing

- In a small room, run the line along one wall instead, from the door to the window. Nobody has to move any furniture for it.
- Moving is the part worth praising out loud. Changing your mind because somebody said something good is a difficult thing to do in front of thirty people, and nobody will do it unless you say that it counts.

Five more statements

1. Rules still matter when nobody is watching.
2. It is fine to give up on something you are not good at.
3. Saying sorry is enough.
4. It is braver to walk away than to argue back.
5. Everyone deserves a second chance.

Make sure you come back for Volume Two. Follow @thepastoralguide to hear when it lands.



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Agree

Stand at this end if you agree with the statement.

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Disagree

Stand at this end if you disagree with the statement.